

SOUTH SOUND PLAYBOOK ★ SUMMER 2026

SUMMER ACTIVITY PACK

20 Epic Things to Do This Summer
for South Sound Kids & Families

■ Outdoors

■ Creative

■ Brain Games

■ Water Fun

WHAT'S INSIDE:

- Nature adventures in South Sound parks
- Creative projects with stuff from home
- Water games for hot summer days
- Fun challenges that sneak in learning
- ■ A Summer Bucket List to fill in together

■ **Get fresh activity ideas every week — FREE**

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Nature Scavenger Hunt

Turn any park into an adventure!

■ Easy

■ 45 min

■ Free

WHAT TO DO

Head to any South Sound park or trail and hunt for items in nature. First one to find everything wins!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

A feather

☐

Something perfectly round

☐

A bug (look, don't touch!)

☐

Something that smells amazing

☐

3 different leaf shapes

☐

Animal tracks or signs

☐

Something older than you

☐

The tallest tree you can find

PRO TIP

■ Try Millersylvania State Park or Tumwater Falls — both amazing for this!



Backyard Campout

No campground needed — just your yard!

■ Easy

■ All night

■ Under \$10

WHAT TO DO

Set up a tent, make s'mores, and sleep under the stars without leaving home. Perfect first camping experience!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

Set up the tent together

☐

Count stars for 10 minutes

☐

Make a "campfire" (candles in a bowl...)

☐

Make s'mores or campfire-style popcorn

☐

Tell spooky stories with a flashlight

☐

Wake up and make "camp breakfast"

PRO TIP

■ No tent? Make a fort with bedsheets draped over chairs!



Butterfly & Bug Safari

Your backyard is a wildlife documentary!

■ Easy

■ 30-60 min

■ Free

WHAT TO DO

Spend 30 minutes observing insects and creatures in your yard or a nearby park. Make a field journal!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

Draw every bug you find

☐

Look under 3 rocks carefully

☐

Time how long a bee visits one flower

☐

Watch an ant trail for 5 minutes

☐

Find a spider web (don't disturb it!)

☐

Try to ID bugs with a free app like...

PRO TIP

■ The free iNaturalist app IDs any bug or plant from a photo — kids go wild for it!



Bike Bingo Adventure

A bingo card that gets you moving!

■ ■ Medium

■ 1 hour

■ Free

WHAT TO DO

Go for a bike ride (or walk!) and try to spot all the bingo squares. First row across = winner!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐ A cat sitting in a window

☐ Someone gardening

☐ A mail truck

☐ Kids playing outside

☐ A flag flying

☐ A vegetable garden

☐ A dog on a walk

☐ Rainbow colors on one house

☐ Someone waving at you

PRO TIP

■ The Chehalis Western Trail is perfect for this — flat and family-friendly!



Water Balloon Olympics

The messiest competition of the summer!

■ Easy

■ 1 hour

■ Under \$5

WHAT TO DO

Set up backyard water balloon games with multiple events. Crown an ultimate Summer Champion!

STEPS & CHALLENGES



Toss & Catch (take a step back each...



Slow walk race — don't drop it!



Under the chin carry race



Target toss into a bucket



Pop it with only your knees



Blindfolded catch (with a helper gu...

PRO TIP

- Self-sealing water balloons (Bunch O Balloons style) make setup 10x faster!



Backyard Splash Day

No pool? No problem!

■ Easy

■ 2-3 hours

■ Under \$5

WHAT TO DO

Turn your backyard into a water park with things you already have. Slip, slide, and splash all day!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

Slip-n-slide with a tarp + dish soap

☐

Frozen water toy dig (freeze toys i...

☐

Sponge tag (soak a sponge, you're i...

☐

Paint the fence with water paintbru...

☐

Sprinkler limbo

☐

Ice cube sculpting race in the sun

PRO TIP

■ A little dish soap on a tarp + a garden hose = best slip-n-slide ever!



Sidewalk Chalk City

Build an entire city on your driveway!

■ Easy

■ 1-2 hours

■ Under \$5

WHAT TO DO

Use chalk to draw a whole town — streets, shops, parks, houses. Then play in it with toy cars or bikes!

STEPS & CHALLENGES



Draw roads with intersections



Add a pond or river



Add a grocery store, park, and school



Let everyone add their own building



Make traffic lights and crosswalks



Ride bikes or scooters on the "roads"



Draw your dream house

PRO TIP

■ Start with the roads first, then fill in buildings — easier to plan!



Make a Mini Movie

Lights, camera, summer action!

■■■ Ambitious

■ Half day

■ Free

WHAT TO DO

Write, direct, and star in your own short film using just a phone. Have a family screening night after!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐ Pick a story (funny is best!)

☐ Write 5-6 scenes on paper

☐ Make costumes from stuff at home

☐ Practice lines once, then just GO

☐ Film 3-5 short clips

☐ Edit in iMovie or CapCut (free apps)

☐ Watch it together with popcorn

PRO TIP

■ Bad acting is the BEST acting — the bloopers are usually the highlight!



Bake & Decorate Extravaganza

Cookie decorating is basically edible art!

■ ■ Medium

■ 2 hours

■ Under \$15

WHAT TO DO

Bake a simple batch of sugar cookies together, then go wild decorating.
Host a judging ceremony!

STEPS & CHALLENGES



Make or buy plain sugar cookies



Give everyone a theme to decorate to



Mix colorful icing (powdered sugar ...



Judge on: creativity, messiness, ta...



Set up decoration stations



Eat your masterpiece (obviously)

PRO TIP

■ Gel food coloring makes way more vivid colors than liquid — totally worth it!



Backyard Mystery Hunt

Create a clue trail for big detective energy!

■ ■ Medium

■ 1-2 hours

■ Free

WHAT TO DO

Hide clues around the yard or house that lead to a final "treasure." Kids write clues for each other!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

Hide 6-8 clues around the house/yard

☐

Each clue leads to the next location

☐

Make clues rhyme for extra fun

☐

Final treasure = a treat or screen ...

☐

Switch roles: kids make a hunt for ...

☐

Time each other for speed runs

PRO TIP

■ "I'm where the dirty clothes go" beats "I'm in the laundry basket" every time!



Around the World in a Day

Visit 5 countries without a passport!

■■ Medium

■ Full day

■ Varies

WHAT TO DO

Pick 5 countries, learn one fact + one word + try one food from each. Make it a whole day event!

STEPS & CHALLENGES

☐

Research each country for 10 minutes

☐

Make or order food from one country

☐

Learn to say "hello" in each language

☐

Draw that country's flag

☐

Find it on a real map or globe

☐

Watch a short YouTube video from th...

PRO TIP

■■ Let each kid pick one country — total buy-in guaranteed!

SUMMER BUCKET LIST

Check off everything you do this summer!

☐ ■ Go swimming somewhere new

☐ ■■ Sleep in a tent

☐ ■ Make something from scratch

☐ ■ Try a new ice cream flavor

☐ ■ Watch a sunrise or sunset

☐ ■ Go fishing

☐ ■ Read 3 books for fun

☐ ■ Bike a new trail

☐ ■ Grow something from a seed

☐ ■ Put on a show for family

☐ ■ Find constellations at night

☐ ■ Bake something delicious

☐ ■ Make a photo journal

☐ ■ Catch and release a bug

☐ ■ Learn a new song

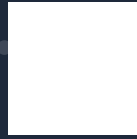
☐ ■ Finish a hard puzzle

☐ ■ Have a watermelon seed-spitting contest

☐ ■ Win a backyard Olympics

☐ ■✉ Write a letter to someone

☐ ■ →■ My own goal: _____



YOU'RE AN OFFICIAL

SOUTH SOUND EXPLORER!

■■ Class of Summer 2026 ■■

Hope this pack sparks an amazing summer.

■ Never run out of ideas

Join families across the South Sound who get
fresh weekend activity ideas every single week.

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Made with ♥■ for South Sound families

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